At this moment of crisis, many refused to serve under anyone else. The Venetian authorities gave in to popular pressure and reinstated the fired admiral, placing him in control of the defense of the city.

VENICE STRIKES BACK

The Genoese did not attempt a direct attack on Venice, depending instead on a blockade by land and sea to reduce the city to surrender. Doge Contarini did seek peace terms from the enemy, but found the price too high to pay. Pisani naturally had no intention of surrendering. On December 21 he launched an operation to turn the tables on the Genoese. Under cover of darkness he sank stone-filled hulks in the channels leading from Chioggia to the open sea. The original besiegers were now the besieged. It still seemed possible that the hungry, demoralized Venetians would be forced to give up the fight when, on January 1, 1380, Carlo Zeno's ships were sighted on the horizon. This tipped the balance of forces decisively in favor of Venice. A Genoese relief fleet led by Matteo Marufo arrived on May 12, but could find no way through to Chioggia.

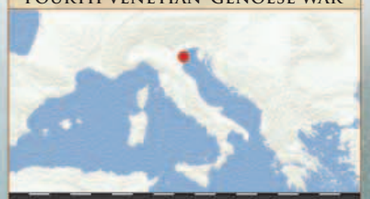
> "TAKE BACK YOUR PRISONERS ... I SHALL BE AT VENICE IN A FEW DAYS TO RELEASE THEM ... FROM YOUR DUNGEONS."
>
> **FRANCESCO DA CARRARA** RULER OF PADUA, REFUSING THE VENETIAN PEACE OFFER

On June 24, the Genoese and their allies inside Chioggia surrendered. When a peace treaty was signed the following year, the terms were equable, but Genoa's attempt to win control of the lucrative trade routes through the eastern Mediterranean had failed. Venetian naval power would not be challenged again until the rise of the Turkish Ottoman Empire.

Venetian galleys outside Chioggia
In this triumphalist painting celebrating Venice's victory over the Genoese in 1380, the galleys depicted are typical 16th-century vessels rather than those in use two centuries earlier.



FOURTH VENETIAN–GENOESE WAR



THE WAR OF CHIOGGIA

Date	August 16, 1379–June 24, 1380
Location	Venice lagoon
Result	Venetian victory

COMBATANTS

VENICE	**GENOA, PADUA, HUNGARY**

COMMANDERS

Vettor Pisani **Carlo Zeno**	**Pietro Doria**

FORCES

Ships: unknown	**Ships:** unknown

LOSSES

Men: unknown **Ships:** unknown	**Men:** unknown **Ships:** unknown